especially abstained from meat'. Badauni also wrote that Akbar shaved the crown of his head, the tenth opening of the body, and let the hairs grow at the sides to allow his soul to escape freely out of the body at the moment of death.

Akbar's interactions with the jogis were scandalous, according to Badauni, but also path-breaking and resulted in Hindu ascetic practices having a pronounced and lasting impact on Indo-Islamic culture. Akbar would have the *Yog Vashisht*, the dialogue between Rama and the Sadhu Vashishta, translated into Persian and would commission miniatures of the jogis of Gorkhatri for the *Baburnama*. Babur himself had barely mentioned his visit to the Gorkhatri but his grandson would have the jogis painted with great realism, showing their distinctive physical features and their particular dress and habits because of his own first-hand observation of them. The singanad janeu, the fillets, and the necklace of coloured cloth of the Nath jogis were all meticulously painted.

In the same spirit of compassion and empathy, Akbar had two caravanserais built outside the city for the housing and feeding of the poor, one for Hindus and one for Muslims, called Dharampurah and Khairpurah respectively. Sarais were built, wrote Abu'l Fazl, 'so that the poor and needy of the world might have a home without having to look for it'. Abu'l Fazl was put in charge of these inns and so many jogis flocked to them that a third place was built, called Jogipurah. Akbar seemed to have been genuinely keen to alleviate poverty and suffering, viewing it as the duty of a king and a virtuous man. 'It was my object that mendicancy should disappear from my dominions,' Akbar claimed. 'Many persons were plentifully supplied with means, but through the malady of avarice,' he continued sadly, 'it proved to no avail.' The rampant 'malady of avarice' or corruption was one that Akbar fought long and hard against. Many of his measures, such as the branding of horses, were brought in to try and curb this deeply entrenched habit. Proof of corruption in trusted men could make him violently angry, as when he discovered that alms sent for distribution to the Haram Sharif in Mecca were unaccounted for and Shaikh Abdullah Sultanpuri's egregious venality had made him hoard gold bars in his house. This was perhaps why Akbar was so very impressed by the vows of poverty undertaken by both the Jesuits and the Jains. They never did accept the truly magnificent gifts and largesse he kept trying to give them and, in the end, this earned them Akbar's abiding respect.